

a younger “cool Britannia” in which the monarchy seemed old-fashioned. Some argued that Britain should become a republic with a president, similar to France or the United States. Newspapers in Canada called Elizabeth “boring.” Australia chose a new national anthem to replace “God Save the Queen.” The Queen could never answer back, of course, even when people were rude about her and her family. Instead, she took note of the criticism and made changes.

In 1997, the Queen and Prince Philip celebrated their golden wedding anniversary. Prince Philip praised her forbearance. She thanked him as her “strength and stay all these years.”



Not all royal partnerships stood the test of time, however. August 1996 had marked the end of the fairy tale, with the divorce of Prince Charles and Princess Diana. Their private lives were private no longer. Books, TV interviews,